

Superintendent's Recommended FY22 Budget Presentation

Dr. Kate Burnham, Superintendent of Schools

Lunenburg Public Schools

Presented March 03, 2021

Mission

The Mission of the Lunenburg Public Schools is to provide all students with the skills, confidence, and passion for life-long learning so that they may find their own paths to successful careers, active citizenship, and rewarding lives.

Vision

The Lunenburg Public Schools is committed to becoming a leader in education by focusing on its values of attending to the personal well-being of its students, providing high-quality curricula and student-centered instruction for deeper learning at all levels, and promoting the development of attributes and skills necessary for continuous learning for all.

Strategy for Continuous Improvement

Transforming Teaching & Learning

To ensure teaching and learning are student-centered and inclusive by establishing effective teams of educational leaders to accomplish the essential work for transforming practice, and hiring and developing excellent educators who are continually learning and adapting practice to meet the needs of all students. (DSP Goals: 1, 2, 3, 5, {4,7})

Communication & Operations

To improve operational efficiencies, including communication, in order to increase the organization's capacity to execute the district's mission and vision. (DSP Goal 8)

Cultivating Climate & Culture

To create a culture that values data use and fosters continuous learning in a climate that is safe, caring, inclusive and reflective of our core values. (DSP Goals 1, 6)

Equity, Access, Opportunity & Achievement for All Students

To ensure all students are provided equal access to a high-quality education, that is collaborative, interactive, and relevant with an appropriate level of support and challenge so that they can become well-rounded, resilient, confident, and capable young adults adequately prepared for future challenges. (DSP Goals 1, 6)

Context

State Mandates & Reporting Since 2010

Data reporting - SIMS, EPIMS, SCS, Restraint, Discipline, School Choice

End-of-Year Financial Report

Increased data collection and reporting for grants

ELA, Math, Science, Social Studies/History, WIDA standards

Computer-based testing ACCESS & MCAS

Educator Evaluation System

Mentor Program Reporting

Accountability System

Medicare reimbursement requirements

Student Opportunity Act 3-year plan

Enrollment Projections FY21-FY23

	FY10	FY11	FY12	FY13	FY14	FY15	FY16	FY17	FY18	FY19	FY20	FY21	FY22	FY23
School/Grade	10/1/2009	10/1/2010	10/1/2011	10/1/2012	10/1/2013	10/1/2014	10/1/2015	10/1/2016	10/1/2017	10/1/2018	10/1/2019	10/1/2020		
PreSchool	52	43	41	49	41	46	43	46	48	46	38	36	46	46
Kindergarten	112	111	116	110	129	112	103	118	109	145	121	108	126	118
Grade 1	120	113	107	118	109	122	116	111	120	114	147	105	137	130
Grade 2	96	113	123	111	126	121	133	116	123	118	111	140	122	139
Lunenburg Primary School TOTAL	328	337	346	339	364	355	352	345	352	377	379	389	385	387
Grade 3	118	98	117	124	107	130	121	134	118	121	120	110	150	133
Grade 4	140	127	112	118	129	115	140	125	131	116	122	112	112	150
Grade 5	128	140	130	115	120	134	118	143	126	136	118	123	125	110
Turkey Hill Elementary School TOTAL	386	365	359	357	356	379	379	402	375	373	360	345	387	393
Grade 6	140	128	144	124	117	119	140	120	153	126	141	126	136	137
Grade 7	127	128	122	144	120	116	120	145	125	144	124	141	130	139
Grade 8	136	129	126	127	147	129	115	123	148	126	141	123	145	133
Lunenburg Middle School TOTAL	403	385	392	395	384	364	375	388	426	396	406	390	411	409
Grade 9	147	123	116	108	110	113	120	114	125	129	107	124	120	122
Grade 10	138	145	133	114	110	114	114	115	109	123	126	113	127	118
Grade 11	132	135	134	117	113	105	113	110	115	103	118	128	108	121
Grade 12	133	131	131	127	111	109	101	103	100	112	101	115	126	108
Lunenburg High School TOTAL	550	534	514	466	444	441	448	442	449	467	452	480	481	469
Ungraded	9	6	6	7	5	6	9	10	10	9	6	8	9	10
TOTAL (NO PRE-K)	1676	1627	1617	1564	1553	1545	1563	1587	1612	1622	1603	1612	1673	1668
Change		-49	-10	-53	-11	-8	18	24	25	10	-19	9	61	-5

2019-2020 Average Class Sizes

Primary School: Pre-K	
Primary School: K-2	20-23 (K, 2) 24-25 (1)
THES: 3-5	24-25
LMS: 6-8	24-26
LHS: 9-12	18-22 (range 8-28)

In 2021-22 we anticipate the return of the majority of students who opted for homeschooling this year.

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Academic Data

Spring 2020 MCAS Achievement & Growth Data – none available

Local Assessment Data

- utilizing a variety of assessments, including IXL, Lexia, iReady, etc.
- administered a fall benchmark and winter benchmark
- Assessment Report presented to School Committee March 3, 2020
 - data support the need for added math intervention, a review of our K-5 math program, and reading intervention

Lunenburg Public Schools

Special Education Data

Evaluations	2019-20	2020-21	Pending 3 yr re-evals		Students on IEPs	
PS	71	58	PS	12	PS	100
THES	28	29	THES	8	THES	64
LMS	25	28	LMS	4	LMS	50
LHS	19	28	LHS	6	LHS	49
TOTAL	143	143	TOTAL	30	TOTAL	273*

We anticipate that with a full return to school next year we will see an increase in parent requests for evaluation.

** Number includes 10 Out-of-District students.*

Lunenburg Public Schools

Section 504 Data

Number of Students on Section 504 Plans (as of 3/3/21)

PS	7
THES	34
LMS	47
LHS	48

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Behavioral Health Data

In October, implemented a universal referral process including form for staff to refer students to the BHST if they have concerns about the students mental health. (data as of 3/3/21)

- Primary School = **10 students identified; 7 new referrals**
- Turkey Hill Elementary = **58 students identified; 10 new referrals**
- Middle School = **25 students identified; 4 new referrals**
- High School = **35 students identified; 4 new referrals***

** does NOT include students requiring continued check ins with staff as a result of Universal Mental Health Screenings. Some will be referred to CBT/DBT Groups starting week of 4/27.*

Recommended FY22 School Department Budget Summary

-Chapter 70 Funding Summary

	FY18	FY19	FY20	FY21
Chapter 70 Budget	\$ 7,272,505	\$ 7,494,174	\$ 7,739,118	\$ 7,773,938
% of Budget supported by Chapter 70 Funds	37.19%	37.34%	37.40%	35.90%

Superintendent of Schools

FY22 Recommended Budget

Lunenburg Public Schools

FY22 Budget Priorities

Develop a budget that meets student needs and aligns with the Strategy for Continuous Improvement objectives:

- Transforming Teaching & Learning;
- Cultivating Climate & Culture;
- Communication & Operations;
- Equity, Access, Opportunity & Achievement for All Students

FY22 School Department Budget Process

August & September

District Leadership Team reviewed and revised the Strategy for Continuous Improvement with a COVID-19 needs lens. The following were aligned with the Strategy objectives: School Improvement Plan goals; superintendent, administrator and teacher educator plan goals.

October

Department leaders and building administrators developed FY22 budget requests focused on highest impact on teaching and learning and alignment with Strategy objectives.

November

Budgets were submitted to the Superintendent and budget line requests were reviewed. Leadership Teams reviewed and revised the 5-Year Staffing Plan.

December

The 5-Year Staffing Plan was finalized and submitted to the Town Manager to be incorporated into the 5-Year Financial Forecast to be presented in January. The Year-1 positions were presented to School Committee as identified needs.

January

The Leadership Team prioritizes the Year-1 positions and identifies those deemed most critical to be included in the FY22 budget. Three (3) budget scenarios were developed and presented to the School Committee.

February

District staff were invited to budget presentation by the Leadership Team. School Committee were provided budget updates at their regularly scheduled meetings.

School Department Budget Increases

- FY20 budget increase was **3%**
- FY21 budget increase was **1.58%**
- Recommended FY22 budget increase is **2.50%**

Recommended FY22 School Department Budget Summary

	FY21 Budget	FY22 Budget	Increase
Personnel	\$ 14,910,126	\$ 15,642,987	4.92 %
Non-Personnel	6,213,477	6,008,705	-3.30 %
TOTAL	\$ 21,123,602	\$ 21,651,692	2.50%

Recommended FY22 School Department Budget Summary

Budget includes:

- Contractual increases: step increases, longevity & degree advancements
- Health insurance: **-0.03% decrease**
- General education transportation increase
- Any proposed new positions
- Salary Reserve

Year 1 of the 5-Year Staffing Plan (FY22-26)

Instructional

Teacher, Grade K, *LPS*

Paraprofessional, Grade K, *LPS*

Teacher, Grade 3, *THES*

Paraprofessional, Reading Tutor,
THES

Leadership

Assistant Principal, *(PK-5)*

Assistant Principal, *(6-12)*

Director of Teaching &
Learning, *District*

**Director of Instructional
Technology &
Communication, District**

Director of Extended Learning
Programs, *District*

Instructional Math Specialist
(K-5)

Services & Supports

Psychologist, *(PK-5)*

Social Worker, *(PK-5)*

**Athletic Trainer, LMHS
Athletics**

**Equipment Manager, LMHS
Athletics**

Technician(s), *District*

**Technology Trainers,
(stipend), District**

Positions in red are not included in the recommended budget nor funded by alternate funding source.

Five Year Staffing Plan is available on the district website (School Committee link, 12/16/20 meeting –Identified Needs)

Recommended FY22 School Department Budget Summary

-New Budgeted Positions

1. Director of Teaching & Learning *(funded between the local budget and revolving account)*
2. Assistant Principal (PK-5)
3. Teacher (K)
4. Paraprofessional (K)
5. Substitute Nurse
6. Director of Extended Learning Programs *(funding from revolving accounts – NO budget impact)*
7. Summer Program *(funding for teachers, counselors, paraprofessionals & site coordinators)*
8. Stipends – Curriculum Team Leaders *(K-8 Core Content Curriculum Leaders -ELA, Math, Science, Social Studies; K-12 Special Area Curriculum Leaders -Art, Music, Health &PE, Library Media & Technology)*

Recommended FY22 School Department Budget Summary

-New Staff Offsets

1. Assistant Principal (6-12) *Offset -Reduce LMHS Guidance staff and Dean positions*
2. Social Worker (PK-2) *Offset -Elimination PS Guidance FTE*
3. Teacher, Grade 3, THES *(transfer teacher from Primary School to follow the bubble class)*

Recommended FY22 School Department Budget Summary

- Grant Funded Positions

1. Social Worker (3-8) *(funded- ESSER II Grant)*
2. Instructional Math Specialist (K-5) *(funded -ESSER II Grant, replacement funded in local budget)*
3. Paraprofessionals, (2) Math and a Reading Tutor, THES *(funded -ESSER II Grant)*
4. Psychologist, (PK-5) *(funded- Special Education Grant)*
5. IT Technician(s), District *(funded -ESSER II Grant)*

Recommended FY22 School Department Budget Summary

Undetermined factors requiring the department to estimate line items:

- Chapter 70 Funding: The Governor's budget included **\$7,773,938** for Town of Lunenburg, a very slight increase from FY21; possibility of adjustment with the final FY22 State Budget.
- Circuit Breaker: Amount will not be released until end of FY21; expecting a value to cover **65%** of costs.
- Federal & State Grants: Allocations are typically not announced for entitlement grants until late July; the district is expecting **level funding**.

Recommended FY22 School Department Budget Summary

Additional factors impacting the budget:

- Bargaining Unit Contracts: There is a reserve budgeted for these pending negotiations with the following employee groups:
 - Teachers (Lunenburg Education Association)
 - Custodians (Lunenburg Custodial Union, AFSCME, Local #503)
 - Paraprofessionals (Lunenburg Paraprofessional Union, AFSCME, Local #503)
 - Food Service Staff (Lunenburg Cafeteria Employees)
- Non-bargaining Unit Contracts: Two employees on individual contracts are up for contract renewal starting on July 1, 2021.

As the Town of Lunenburg continues to see growth and demographic changes, level service budgets will not allow the district to continue to perform at or above the state in terms of student achievement and growth. We need to invest in the operational budget of the schools to ensure that we can continue to meet our students' needs.

FY22 School Department Budget Timeline

- Staff Presentations (*Jan/Feb*)
- Town Manager's Target Budget (*January*)
- Budget Q&A sessions SC meetings (*February 3 and March 3*)
- Budget Updates to School Committee & Families (*February 24, 2021*)
- Budget Hearing/School Committee Approval (*March 17, 2021*)
- Lunenburg Finance Committee Presentation (*March 18, 2021*)
- Town Meeting (*May 1, 2021*)



Questions?
